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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP(HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION, March 2026

Fourth Semester

Value Addition Course (VAC)-MG$VACBTS200-HUMAN RIGHTS AND GENDER EQUALITY

(2024 admission onwards)

Part A

Answer all questions

1.The right to education and health care fall under……rights. [K] / [CO1]

Social / Economic

2.Gender……..means giving equal rights and opportunities to all genders. [K] / [CO5]

Equality

3.All human rights are ……..,indivisible and interdependent. [K] / [CO1]

Universal

4.The right to……is provided under articles 25 to 28. [K] / [CO1]

Right to freedom of religion

5.The National Human Rights Commission investigates cases related to the violation of……..[K] / [CO2]

Human Rights

6……refers to individuals who don't identify as exclusively male or female. [K] / [CO4]

Non-binary

7.Gender……refers to unequal treatment or perceptions of individuals based on their gender. [K] / [CO3]

Discrimination

8.Employers are responsible for providing a safe and respectful……..[K] / [CO3]

Working environment

9.Domestic violence is a common form of gender-based ……..[K] / [CO5]

Violence

10.The ……is considered a key early document in the development of human rights. [K] / [CO1]

Magna Carta

Part B

11.What are Articles 14 to 18 of Indian constitution guarantees about? [K] / [CO2]

Articles 14 to 18 covers Right to Equality.

12.State any two forms of work place harassment? [K] / [CO3]

Unlawful harassment includes offensive conduct that becomes a condition of employment or creates a hostile environment. Sexual harassment in the workplace is defined as unwanted sexual advances or comments after expressing disinterest

13.What are some human rights concerns in India? [K] / [CO3]

Human rights issues in India include rising violence against religious minorities and Dalits, restrictions on freedom of expression and media, and use of repressive laws against activists. Significant concerns involve police impunity, caste-based violence, forced evictions, and ethnic clashes, particularly in regions like Manipur and Jammu and Kashmir.

14.What is the difference between gender identity and gender expression? [K] / [CO5]

Gender identity is a person's deep internal sense of being a man, woman, neither, or both, while gender expression is how they outwardly present their gender to the world through clothing, behaviour, and appearance. Identity is internal and personal; expression is external and communicative.

15.Write two examples for practical gender needs. [K] / [CO4]

Examples of Practical Gender Needs:

- Infrastructure & Utilities: Access to safe, clean water supplies and sanitation facilities.
- Health & Nutrition: Maternal healthcare services, family planning services, and nutrition programs for children.
- Income & Productivity: Access to credit/financial services, childcare centres, and employment opportunities to support the family.
- Living Conditions: Improvement of housing, fuel-efficient cooking stoves, and community infrastructure (e.g., schools, clinics).

16.Give an example of human rights violation. [K] / [CO3]

Examples of Human Rights Violations include

- Torture and Degrading Treatment: Acts of torture, rape, or cruel treatment committed or tolerated by public officials, such as police brutality.

- Arbitrary Detention and Free Speech Violations: Arresting or imprisoning individuals for peaceful protests, political opposition, or journalists for reporting, such as the detention of protesters.

17.Write any two roles of NHRC. [K] / [CO2]

Key roles of the NHRC include:

- Investigative & Preventive Role: It has the power to inquire into violations of human rights (such as custodial deaths or police excesses). It can also visit jails and detention centres to monitor the living conditions of inmates.
- Advisory & Evaluative Role: It reviews the effectiveness of existing laws and constitutional protections for human rights and advises the government on implementing international human rights treaties.

18. What do gender roles determine? [K] / [CO4]

The gender roles include:

- Division of Labour: Traditionally, this sets roles like breadwinner for men and nurturer/homemaker for women.
- Occupational Choices: Gender Roles influence which professions are deemed appropriate, creating occupational segregation, such as women in caregiving roles and men in technical fields.

19.Write the importance of fundamental duties in promoting human rights. [K] / [CO1]

Fundamental duties promote human rights include:

- Balancing Rights and Obligations: Duties act as a moral counterpart to Fundamental Rights, ensuring that rights are not exercised in a vacuum but with responsibility toward the community.
- Preventing Abuse of Rights: They act as a warning against actions that violate the rights of others, such as damaging public property or promoting communal disharmony.

20.Write two examples for occupational stereotypes. [K] / [CO4]

Occupational stereotypes are oversimplified beliefs about specific jobs, often based on gender or personality traits. Common examples include the belief that nurses are inherently nurturing

females (gender stereotype) or that salespeople are manipulative and self-interested (behavioural stereotype).

21.What is the concept of indivisibility of human rights? [K] / [CO1]

The indivisibility of human rights is the principle that all rights—civil, political, economic, social, and cultural—are inseparable, equal in importance, and inherent to human dignity. No right is superior to another, and the enjoyment of one often depends on the realization of others.

22.What is UDHR? [K] / [CO1]

The Universal Declaration of Human Rights (UDHR) is a milestone document adopted by the UN General Assembly on December 10, 1948, in Paris, defining fundamental human rights to be universally protected.

Part C

23.Describe the different types of genders. [K] / [CO4]

The different gender identities are

- Cisgender: People whose gender identity matches the sex they were assigned at birth.
- Transgender: An umbrella term for people whose gender identity differs from the sex they were assigned at birth (e.g., trans man, trans woman).
- Non-binary: A spectrum of gender identities that are not exclusively masculine or feminine, falling outside the traditional male-female binary.
- Agender: People who do not identify with any gender, or who feel they have no gender.
- Genderfluid: Someone whose gender identity is not fixed and shifts or fluctuates over time.
- Genderqueer: A term for people who do not subscribe to conventional gender distinctions and may blend or move between genders.

24.Comment in detail on biological sex and gender. [K] / [CO4]

Biological Sex

- Definition: Based on physiological features—chromosomes and hormones

- Assignment: Assigned at birth as male or female based on physical appearance.

Gender

- Definition: The socially constructed roles, behaviours, expressions, and identities that society considers appropriate for men, women, and gender-diverse people.
- Components:
    - Gender Identity: An internal, deeply felt sense of self (e.g., man, woman, nonbinary).
    - Gender Expression: How a person presents their gender outwardly, such as through clothing or behaviour.
    - Gender Roles: Social expectations of how to act or behave based on assigned sex.

25.Analyze the role of HR in preventing and addressing work place harassment. [K] / [CO3]

HR's Role in Prevention of work place harassment:

- Policy Development & Communication: HR must create clear, comprehensive anti-harassment policies that define prohibited conduct, reporting procedures, and consequences.
- Training & Education: Regular, mandatory workshops for all staff and specialized training for leadership/investigation committees (such as IC in India) ensure awareness.
- Cultural Transformation: Actively promoting a respectful, safe, and inclusive environment through communication channels like posters, emails, and meetings.

26.Explain in detail gender expression. [K] / [CO5]

Gender expression is the external manifestation of a person’s gender, displayed through clothing, hairstyle, makeup, mannerisms, speech patterns, and behaviours. It is how individuals present their gender to the world, which may or may not align with their internal gender identity or societal expectations of masculinity or feminine

Key aspects of Gender Expression

- External Presentation: Unlike internal gender identity, expression is how one is perceived by others.

- Social & Cultural Norms: Expression is interpreted based on societal stereotypes, such as masculine, feminine, or androgynous.
- Independence from Identity/Sex: A person’s expression does not have to match their biological sex or their internal sense of gender.

27.Discuss the causes of gender discrimination in society. [K] / [CO5]

Primary Causes of Gender Discrimination

- Patriarchal Society and Gender Roles: A dominant structure where men hold power, influencing family and societal decisions. Society often expects women to adhere strictly to caregiving roles, limiting their potential.
- Social Customs and Beliefs: Deep-seated preferences for male children and the devaluation of daughters lead to discrimination, including dowry systems, sex-selective abortions, and neglect of the girl child.
- Economic Disparity and Dependency: Women often face lower wages, fewer career opportunities, and a lack of ownership or inheritance rights, forcing economic dependency on male counterparts.
- Lack of Education and Literacy: Educational imbalances, particularly in developing areas, restrict girls' opportunities, limiting their awareness of rights and ability to challenge norms.

28.Explain the different concepts of human rights. [K] / [CO1]

Characteristics of Human Rights

- Universal: Applicable to everyone across the globe, as stated in the Universal Declaration of Human Rights (UDHR).
- Inalienable: They cannot be taken away or surrendered, except in specific, lawful situations.
- Indivisible and Interdependent**:** All rights (civil, political, social) are equally important and connected; one cannot fully enjoy one set of rights without the others.

29.Explain the powers and functions of National Human Rights Commission. [K] / [CO2]

Functions of the NHRC

- Inquiry: Investigates human rights violations or negligence by public servants through petitions.
- Court Intervention: Intervenes in court proceedings involving human rights issues with court permission.
- Jail Inspections: Visits jails and detention centres to study living conditions and recommend improvements.
- Legal Review: Reviews constitutional and legal safeguards for human rights protection and recommends effective implementation measures.

Powers of the NHRC

- Civil Court Powers: While investigating, the commission acts as a civil court.
- Investigation Team: It has its own investigative staff to examine complaints.
- Recommendations: Can recommend compensation to victims or prosecution of the guilty to governments.
- Immediate Action: Can recommend interim relief to victims.